

Academic Calendar Planning – MCA Semester 3

Faculty planning document for semester scheduling and academic activities

Semester Commencement

The academic calendar for MCA Semester 3 begins with a one week orientation and course introduction period during which each subject faculty presents the course outline, evaluation scheme, and reference materials for their respective subjects. This period also includes a diagnostic assessment for programming subjects such as Java, used to identify students who may require additional support sessions early in the semester rather than after the first internal examination has already taken place.

Regular instruction commences in the second week, with the full timetable of lectures, tutorials, and laboratory sessions coming into effect. Faculty are expected to have their lesson plans for the first two modules finalized before this date, so that instructional pacing can be monitored against the planned schedule from the very first week.

Internal Examinations

Two internal examinations are scheduled for each subject during the semester, positioned to align with natural breakpoints in the syllabus rather than falling on fixed calendar dates common to all subjects, since forcing every subject to test the same content window creates uneven preparation burden for students in weeks when several internals coincide. The first round of internal examinations is planned around the middle of the semester, after the first two or three modules of each subject have been completed, and the second round is planned roughly three weeks before the semester examinations begin.

A buffer period of one week is deliberately left open between the two rounds of internal examinations to allow faculty time to evaluate answer scripts, provide feedback, and conduct remedial sessions for students who underperformed in the first round before the second round of testing begins.

Assignment Schedules

Assignments across all subjects are coordinated through a shared academic planning calendar maintained at the department level, which prevents multiple subjects from setting overlapping deadlines in the same week. Each subject is permitted a maximum of two major assignments per semester, staggered so that no student faces more than one assignment deadline in any given week during the middle third of the semester, which is typically the busiest period once regular coursework, laboratory work, and assignment work all overlap.

Assignment topics are finalized and communicated to students at least three weeks before the submission deadline, giving adequate time for research, implementation where applicable, and faculty consultation during office hours for students who require clarification on requirements.

Seminars

A departmental seminar series is scheduled at regular intervals throughout the semester, typically once every three weeks, featuring either invited industry speakers or senior faculty presenting on emerging topics relevant to the MCA curriculum, such as cloud database services, distributed systems, or current

trends in software engineering practice. These seminars are scheduled outside of regular instructional hours to avoid disrupting the planned lecture schedule, typically during a common free period shared across all sections.

Attendance at seminars is tracked as part of overall student engagement records, and students are encouraged to prepare questions in advance, particularly when the seminar topic connects directly to a subject being studied that semester, such as a seminar on NoSQL databases scheduled to complement the relational database concepts covered in the core DBMS course.

Project Reviews

Mini project reviews for Semester 3 are conducted in two stages, a proposal review conducted approximately six weeks into the semester and a final review conducted approximately two weeks before the semester examinations. The proposal review evaluates the feasibility, scope, and academic relevance of each student's or team's proposed project, while the final review assesses the completed implementation, documentation quality, and the team's ability to answer questions about design decisions during a short viva voce.

Faculty mentors are assigned to project teams shortly after the proposal review to provide ongoing guidance, and progress check-ins are scheduled informally between the two formal review stages so that significant issues with project scope or implementation can be identified and corrected well before the final review.

University Examinations

The end semester university examinations are scheduled after all internal assessments, assignments, and project reviews have concluded, with a dedicated study leave period of approximately one week preceding the first examination date to allow students focused revision time without competing instructional obligations. The examination timetable is structured to leave at least one day between consecutive theory papers wherever the university's overall examination calendar permits, reducing the likelihood of back-to-back examinations in subjects with heavy syllabi such as DBMS and Software Engineering.

Practical and laboratory examinations are scheduled either immediately before or interspersed within the theory examination period depending on laboratory availability, and students are notified of their specific practical examination slots at least one week in advance to allow adequate preparation time for viva voce components accompanying each laboratory examination.